PA Faculty Job Market: Candidate Pulse — October 2026

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Monthly pulse check for PhD candidates — October 13, 2026

I've picked up 29 new PA / PP tenure-track postings since the previous snapshot (2026-09-02), including searches at University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, University of North Florida, University of California-Berkeley and 26 other institutions. Of those, 19 are Assistant Professor searches and 10 are senior or open-rank. Across all ranks, the PA and PP panels added a net 49 *canonical* postings (de-duplicated — one row per real search after merging cross-postings) since 2026-09-02. We're in the fall window. October volume sits below the July–August peak; most active searches now are carry-overs nearing decision.

What's changed since 2026-09-02

Metric	Previous	Current	Change
Assistant Professor TT postings (PA + PP)	95	114	+19
Senior or open-rank TT postings (PA + PP)	49	59	+10
PA postings (all ranks, canonical)	309	329	+20
Public policy postings (canonical)	266	295	+29
Political science postings (canonical)	481	537	+56
Canonical postings (all disciplines)	17,393	20,909	+3,516
OpenAlex author profiles linked	614	628	+14
Career observations	22,472	96,441	+73,969

New PA / PP tenure-track postings

Tenure-track searches I first observed since the previous snapshot (2026-09-02), split by rank. Assistant Professor is the slot most first-time TT candidates are targeting; senior or open-rank searches are useful context for where the field is moving. Click any title to open the listing.

Assistant Professor

Title	Institution	Location
Assistant Professor Employment Law	University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill	NC
Assistant Professor	University of North Florida	FL
Assistant Professor – Civics Education – Berkeley School of E...	University of California-Berkeley	Berkeley, CA
Assistant Professor, Department of Health Sciences	Boston University	Boston, MA
Assistant Professor of Architecture	The University of Texas at Arlington	
Assistant Professor, Public Management and Policy	University of Illinois Springfield	Springfield, IL
Department of Marketing - Assistant Professor of Hospitality	California State University-Los Angeles	San Bernardino - San Bernardino Campus, CA
Assistant Professor in Criminal Justice System	University of Florida	Main Campus (Gainesville, FL)
Assistant Professor of Economics & Public Policy	Cornell University	Ithaca, NY
Assistant Professor/Associate Professor in Public Policy – Re...	The University of Alabama	Alabama, AL
Assistant Professor/ Associate Professor/ Full Professor	Northeastern University Oakland	CA
Assistant Professor	University of Massachusetts-Amherst	UMass Boston, MA
Assistant Professor, Public Policy and Management with a Focu...	Iowa State University	OH
Assistant Professor in High-level Human Cognition	University of California-San Diego	La Jolla, CA
Assistant Professor of Political Science	University of Arkansas	AR
Energy Geoscience	Duke University	Durham, NC
Assistant Professor Position School of Social Work	California State University-Los Angeles	Chico, CA
Assistant Professor , Undergraduate Law	Suffolk University	MA
Assistant Professor, Public/Nonprofit Management	University of Connecticut	UConn Hartford, CT

Senior or open-rank

Title	Institution	Location
Open-Rank,Tenured/TT Position in Cybersecurity and Privacy	Georgia Institute of Technology-Main Campus	Atlanta, GA
Assistant / Associate Professor of Educational Leadership and…	Wayne State University	Detroit, MI
Eads Professor of the Practice in Energy	Duke University	Durham, NC
Democracy and Public Policy	Cornell University	Ithaca, NY
Hennebach Visiting Assistant or Associate Professor, Humaniti…	Colorado School of Mines	CO
Faculty Position in Data Science and Society	Georgetown University	Doha
Faculty Position in Health and Environment	Georgetown University	Doha
UCI - TT Assistant or Tenured Associate Professor Faculty Pos…	University of California-Irvine	Irvine, CA
Associate Professor of Political Science and Coordinator, Mas…	East Tennessee State University	TN, United States
Asst/Assoc/Full Prof - Addictions and Behavioral Health Focus	University of Connecticut	School of Social Work, CT

How we're doing relative to expectations

I don't have a clean year-over-year comparison for September 2026 yet — the live scrapers came online in April 2026, so prior years are Wayback-sampled and thin. The seasonality shape in the figure below is still the right calibration tool; year-over-year context sharpens as more cycles accumulate. The chart below shows the underlying shape: PA and PP postings stacked by calendar month, pooled across the complete sampled years (2016–2025). I recommend candidates use it as a calibration tool. Volume arrives in *two waves* — the larger in July–August and a second in January (each about 13% of the year) — while **May and December are the two dead months** (roughly 1% each). Read the comparison above against this typical pattern to see where the current cycle sits.

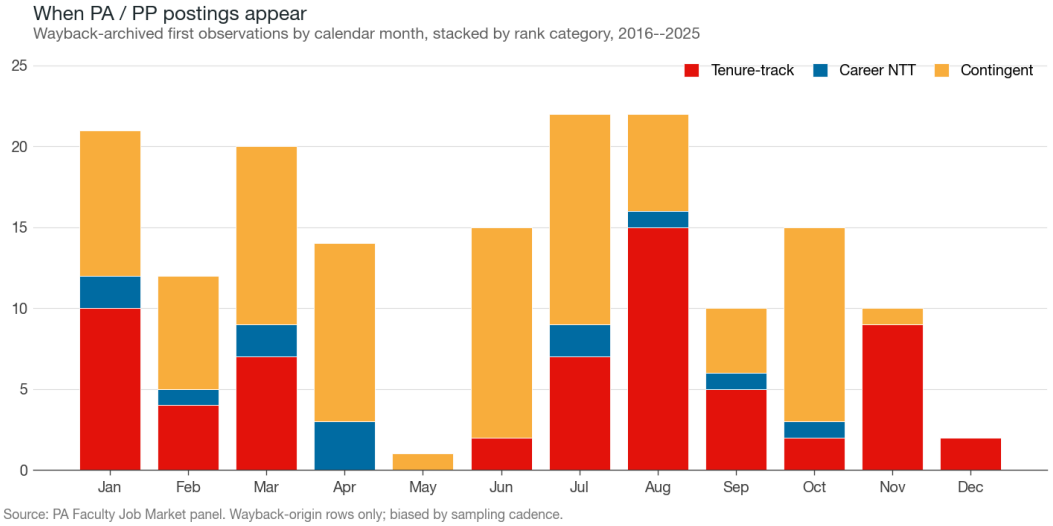


Figure 1. Stacked PA + PP postings by calendar month, complete sampled years (2016–2025). Two waves — July–August (largest) and January — with May and December the dead months (∼1% each).

Suggestions

This pulse is a work in progress, and I'd genuinely like to hear what's not landing for you. If something's missing, miscounted, mis-framed, or just unclear, let me know — the panel and the prose both get better when I know what readers actually want. A short feedback form is in the works; in the meantime, click here to open a reply with the right subject line pre-filled, or just reply to this email directly.

For the full picture

I keep this monthly pulse intentionally short. The companion annual *Candidate Edition* carries the rest of the analysis: the three-cluster placement typology, productivity trajectories by placement type, top destinations, geography, subfields in demand, and the methodological transparency you need to interpret the headline numbers. I update it once per year, typically in summer ahead of the new application cycle — reply if you'd like the latest copy.

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Candidate Edition (monthly). The annual Candidate Edition and the annual Institutional Edition are posted separately. This monthly pulse regenerates on the first of each month from the `faculty_market_analysis` *panel. Build system: Claude Code (Anthropic).*